

St. Alexis of Wilkes-Barre Orthodox Church

A Mission of the Orthodox Church in America

2323 N State St, Unit 112, Bunnell, FL 32110

Sunday Divine Liturgy 9:30 AM

Confessions heard Saturday after Great Vespers or by appointment

SUNDAY, AUGUST 2

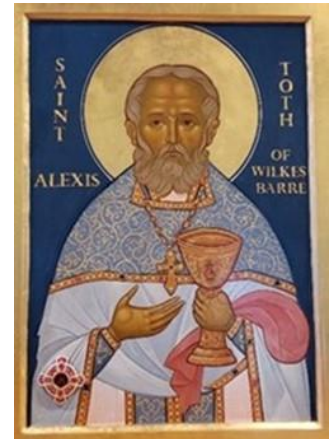
TONE 8

9th Sunday after Pentecost

Translation of the Relics of the Protomartyr and Archdeacon Stephen from Jerusalem to Constantinople



“The Orthodox Christian Church
is evangelical, but not Protestant.
It is orthodox, but not Jewish.
It is catholic, but not Roman.
It is not denominational,
it is pre-denominational.
It has believed, taught, preserved, defended,
and died for the Faith of the Apostles
since the Day of Pentecost
nearly 2,000 years ago.”
– *Our Life in Christ*



Welcome to our Guests!

Thank you for coming to pray with us. You will find a blue guest information card next to the weekly bulletin with today's hymns on the table where you entered. Please fill out the card and give it to a greeter or to our priest, Fr David, who looks forward to meeting you! You are also invited to *Coffee Fellowship* in the parish hall following the Liturgy this morning.

According to ancient Christian practice, Holy Communion (Eucharist) is served to members of the Orthodox Church who have made preparation through prayer, fasting, and recent confession, and who are at peace with their neighbor. If you are not a member of the Orthodox Church, you may be offered blessed bread (*antidoron*) by others in respect and love.

Announcements:

Orthodox Conversations with Fr David after Coffee Fellowship Hour

Fr David facilitates this informal session on designated Sundays. *Check the calendar and look for "Orthodox Conversations with Fr David."* Catechumens, please make it a priority to attend –all others are welcome to join in. If you are a guest, seeker, inquirer, or member, this is an opportunity to learn more about Orthodox faith and practice. We meet in the nave.

August 1 – beginning of the Dormition Fast

The Dormition Fast began Saturday, August 1, ushering in the final season of prayer, fasting, and almsgiving. We began the church year in September with feasts that brought us to the Cross and the Theotokos (incarnation), contemplating how to begin our lives and how to live them. Now we come to the end of the church year in August and once again we have the Cross and the Theotokos, but this time we contemplate the end of our lives and the legacy we will leave. In classical Christianity, Mary is

not the great exception, she is the great example of what it means to be a Christian. How do you want to be remembered? What will your legacy be here at St. Alexis Church? The problem is never that we expect too much from God. The problem is that we expect and ask for so little.

Great Vespers with Litya 6pm Wednesday in celebration of the Feast of the Transfiguration: We will return Wednesday evening for Great Vespers and Litya at 6:00 pm. The texts from the Old Testament which we hear during Great Vespers of the Feast of the Transfiguration begin with the account of Moses on Mt. Sinai where God gives the Law written on stone tablets (Exodus 24:12-18). Now, in the Transfiguration, God reveals His Son in His glory, standing with Moses. The next reading is also from Exodus when Moses asks to see God's glory, of which we glimpse in the Transfiguration. We also read two episodes from the life of the great prophet, Elijah, who also appears with Jesus (3 Kings 19 LXX). Jesus is the fulfillment of all law and all prophecy, the completion of the Old Testament Covenant. The Transfiguration, the procession of the cross, and the Dormition of the Theotokos bring closure to the church year ending on August 31.

Invitation to Bring Fruit this Wednesday evening for the Blessing of First-Fruits

Fr Alexander Schmemmann wrote: *"On the Transfiguration we bring to church apples, pears, grapes, vegetables, and suddenly the church itself is transformed anew into that mystical garden, into that blessed paradise where man's life and his encounter with God began. And just as that first man rejoiced and gave thanks to God as he opened his eyes for the first time and saw this world where everything, by God's own word, was 'very good,' so in this rite of blessing we see the world as if for the first time, as the reflection of God's wisdom and love, and we rejoice and give thanks. And through this joy and thanksgiving our life is purified, renewed and reborn"* (Celebration of Faith, Vol 2, p 161).

All are invited to bring fruits, vegetables and herbs to the table in the front of the nave where they will be blessed following Great Vespers.

Want to schedule time during the week with Fr David for confession or pastoral counsel? There's an app for that...or at least a link!

<https://outlook.office.com/book/ScheduletimewithFrDavidPriestatStAlexisMission@synergylife.coach/?ismsaljsauthenabled>

Please note that any meeting scheduled with him will be **at the church** unless otherwise requested.

Encouraging ACH donations at St. Alexis for Tithes and Offerings and the Building Fund

We encourage online donors to choose **ACH** rather than credit card transactions. Our parish is charged a 2.2% transaction fee for each credit card donation. In contrast, we are charged only \$.25 for each ACH donation. To donate via ACH, register with **Church Connect**, a one-time, quick, secure set up:

Church Connect - Our St Alexis Orthodox Church App

- Scan the **QR code** with your smart phone to create your account
- You may also go directly to the link at: stalexisoca.org/give
- If you need help setting up your account, see Mka Rozanne or Mike Ruddy



NEW ONGOING Opportunities for Love and Ministry in our Parish:

- ❖ **Volunteer for October Medical Team in Guatemala.** Medical professionals are needed for a mission team this October 15-25 at Ascension Orthodox Church in Pebilpam, Guatemala (on map). Primary care providers and dentists are especially needed. Prospective applicants should see Fr. David for further direction.

- ❖ **The Mission Center is Hiring—Spread the Word!** The Orthodox Christian Mission Center (OCMC) is hiring for several positions, including Missionary Director and Assistant Missionary Director for Mobilization. If you know potential candidates, please encourage them to apply (info here).
- ❖ **Seeking Altar Servers:** Men and boys of all ages, if you are a member of the faithful and are open to being trained to serve in the altar, please see Fr David. *You must arrive 30 minutes before the service begins.*
- ❖ **Church Cleaning Time happens every Wednesday 3:30-5:30pm (Vespers begins at 6pm).** Nelya Lashkul is a steward of this ministry. Ask her how you can help or contact the church office.
- ❖ **We are looking for volunteers for church projects and assistance in the office.** Come by the church office during office hours and ask, “How can I help?”
- ❖ **Child Care:** Interested in helping our catechumens by providing supervision for their children during catechism each Wednesday 6:30-7:30pm? This is a special ministry requiring at least two qualified adults each Wednesday evening. An honorarium may be available if needed for this ministry. See Fr David or Mka Rozanne to learn more.
 - NOTE: According to OCA policies, anyone who works with children in the parish must submit to a background check and complete a briefing process. There must be two adults caring for children at all times unless the children are with a parent or relative.

Prayer Lists – Pray for each other daily:

The Departed:

- The Priest Slava
- Fr John
- Fr Peter
- Ruth
- Pres Krissy
- Ron
- Alice
- Timothy
- Galina
- Victims of accidents, hostilities, and natural disasters around the world

All whom we carry in our hearts, including:

- Fr Aleksandr Yu Shi, Fr. Kung Ming Cheung, Fr. Denis
- Fr Patrick, Mka Lauren, James, Walter, Henry, Kathryn, Ethan, Marissa & the child she carries, Andrew
- Fr Nicholas & Mka Anastasia, Fr Philip & Kh Diane, Fr James & Mka Daphne & Peter, Fr Jordan & Mka Vanessa
- Our missionaries: the Hoppes, Brandows, Macdonalds, and Hannah Valentine
- Iconographer Elena & family; Iconographers Anya & Victor
- Wood craftsmen Artem, Zachary, Daniel, James
- Helen, Ilya, Moses, Michael, Elena, Stefan, Naomi, Danica, Stela, Gordana, Larry, Gabriel, Elizabeth
- Anna and the child newly born of her, Nadia and the child newly born of her
- Amy and the child she carries, Kenadea Mary and the child she carries
- All members of our community traveling or on the bed of sickness
- All who are homeless, unemployed, or under-employed in our community
- All of our guests and inquirers seeking God through the Orthodox Church
- Catechumens Chris, Lesly, Gianna, Marco, Samuel, Maryam, Annie, Gillian, Tyler, Vincent & Amy

Hymns for this Sunday: *Please sing along with the choir – and all week long!*

Tone 8 Troparion (Resurrection)

Thou didst descend from on high, O Merciful One!
Thou didst accept the three day burial to free us from our sufferings!//
O Lord, our Life and Resurrection, glory to Thee!

Tone 4 Troparion (St. Alexis)

O righteous Father Alexis,
our heavenly intercessor and teacher,
divine adornment of the Church of Christ!
Entreat the Master of All
To strengthen the Orthodox Faith in America,
To grant peace to the world //
And to our souls great mercy.

Tone 4 Troparion (St. Stephen)

Your relics have risen from the depths of the earth,
like a treasury for the immortal life of all creation.
The Church, rejoicing in the grace that she receives from them,
dutifully honors you, O Protomartyr Stephen.//
Preserve us from error and heresy by your intercession!

Tone 8 Kontakion (Resurrection)

By rising from the tomb, Thou didst raise the dead and resurrect Adam.
Eve exults in Thy Resurrection,//
and the world celebrates Thy rising from the dead, O greatly Merciful One!

Tone 6 Kontakion (St. Stephen)

You were the first to be sown on the earth by the Heavenly Husbandman, O all-praised one,
and were the first to shed your blood on the earth for Christ, O blessed one.
You were the first to receive the crown of victory from Him in heaven,//
O Stephen, first of the suffering God-crowned martyrs.

Tone 6 Kontakion (Steadfast Protectress of Christians)

Steadfast Protectress of Christians,
Constant Advocate before the Creator;
despise not the entreating cries of us sinners,
but in your goodness come speedily to help us who call on you in faith.
Hasten to hear our petition and to intercede for us, O Theotokos, //
for you always protect those who honor you!

Scripture Readings for this Sunday:

Epistle: 1 Corinthians 3:9-17

Gospel: Matthew 14:22-34

*You know who you are!
Your cheerful offerings of time, talent, and treasure
are a blessing to us all!*



Life in our Church

Dormition Fast August 1-15 (no meat, eggs, or dairy)

Saturday, August 1 **Choir Rehearsal** (*in the nave*) **3:30 PM**
Great Vespers (*Confessions following*) **5:00 PM**
Procession of the Cross (with prayers for healing)

Sunday, Aug 2 **Divine Liturgy of St. John Chrysostom** **9:30 AM**
Coffee Fellowship Hour (no meat, eggs, or dairy)
Orthodox Conversations with Fr David **~12:15 PM**

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Wednesday, August 5 **Church Cleaning** **3:30 PM**
Festal Great Vespers with Litya **6:00 PM**
(Feast of the Transfiguration of our Lord)
Catechism **7:00 PM**

Thursday, August 6 Feast of the Transfiguration of our Lord

Saturday, August 8 **Choir Rehearsal** (*in the nave*) **3:30 PM**
Great Vespers (*Confessions following*) **5:00 PM**

Sunday, Aug 9 **Divine Liturgy of St. John Chrysostom** **9:30 AM**
Coffee Fellowship Hour (no meat, eggs, or dairy)
Orthodox Conversations with Fr David **~12:15 PM**

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Wednesday, August 12 **Parish Council Meeting** **3:30 PM**
Church Cleaning **3:30 PM**
Daily Vespers **6:00 PM**
Catechism **6:30 PM**

Saturday, August 15 Feast of the Dormition of the Most Holy Theotokos

Saturday, August 15 **Divine Liturgy of St. John Chrysostom** **9:30 AM**
(Feast of the Dormition of the Most Holy Theotokos)
Choir Rehearsal (*in the nave*) **3:30 PM**
Great Vespers (*Confessions following*) **5:00 PM**

Sunday, Aug 16 **Divine Liturgy of St. John Chrysostom** **9:30 AM**
Coffee Fellowship Hour (feasting!)
Hannah Valentine our missionary in Albania! **~12:15 PM**

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His Grace, The Right Rev. GERASIM, Bishop of Ft. Worth, *Locum Tenens* of the Diocese of the South
 Archpriest David C. Rucker ♦ 904-599-5812 ♦ priest@stalexisoca.org
 Parish Council President James Humphries ♦ 904-540-2476